SOC101

General Sociology Concepts

1. **Sociology**
   Definition: The systematic and scientific study of human behavior, social groups, and society.
   Example: Studying how social norms influence individual behavior in different cultures.
2. **Social Groups**
   Definition: Groups of individuals who interact and share a sense of unity.
   Example: Families, clubs, and workplaces are examples of social groups.
3. **Social Phenomena**
   Definition: Observable events or actions that arise from human interactions.
   Example: The rise of social media as a platform for activism.
4. **Social Structures**
   Definition: Patterns of organized relationships and social arrangements within a society.
   Example: The hierarchical structure of a corporation or the caste system.
5. **Social Norms**
   Definition: Accepted behaviors and expectations within a society.
   Example: Shaking hands as a greeting in Western cultures.
6. **Sociological Perspective**
   Definition: A viewpoint for understanding human behavior within its broader social context.
   Example: Analyzing poverty not just as individual failure but as a result of systemic inequality.
7. **Social Contexts**
   Definition: The cultural, economic, and societal settings in which people live and interact.
   Example: The differing social expectations in rural versus urban areas.
8. **Sociological Imagination**
   Definition: The ability to see the link between personal experiences and larger social forces.
   Example: Connecting personal unemployment to global economic downturns.
9. **Social Facts**
   Definition: Values, cultural norms, and social structures that transcend individuals but constrain their behavior.
   Example: Laws, religious beliefs, or marriage traditions.
10. **Social Stratification**
    Definition: A system by which society ranks categories of people in a hierarchy.
    Example: Class systems in capitalist societies.

Foundational Theories and Thinkers

11. **Auguste Comte**
    Definition: The founder of sociology who introduced positivism, emphasizing observation and scientific methods.
    Example: His law of three stages (theological, metaphysical, and positive) describes societal development.
12. **Positivism**
    Definition: The application of the scientific method to the study of social phenomena.
    Example: Using statistical analysis to study crime rates.
13. **Herbert Spencer**
    Definition: Sociologist known for applying evolutionary theory to societies, coining "survival of the fittest."
    Example: His work influenced Social Darwinism.
14. **Social Darwinism**
    Definition: The belief that societies evolve like organisms, with "fittest" cultures thriving.
    Example: Justifying capitalism as a natural hierarchy.
15. **Karl Marx**
    Definition: Philosopher who introduced conflict theory, emphasizing class struggle and economic systems.
    Example: His ideas are foundational in studying capitalism and socialism.
16. **Class Conflict**
    Definition: The struggle between social classes for resources and power.
    Example: The proletariat versus bourgeoisie dynamic in industrial societies.
17. **Emile Durkheim**
    Definition: Sociologist who explored social cohesion and the impact of social facts on behavior.
    Example: His study on suicide demonstrated the effects of social integration.
18. **Mechanical Solidarity**
    Definition: Social cohesion in traditional societies based on shared values and similarities.
    Example: Tribal societies where everyone contributes to farming and rituals.
19. **Organic Solidarity**
    Definition: Social cohesion in modern societies based on interdependence and specialization.
    Example: Urban communities where different professions depend on each other.
20. **Collective Conscience**
    Definition: The shared beliefs and moral attitudes of a society.
    Example: National pride during independence celebrations.

Compilation

Research Methods

21. **Research Design**
    Definition: A structured approach to conducting research.
    Example: Choosing a qualitative method to study cultural practices.
22. **Survey Method**
    Definition: Collecting data through questionnaires or interviews.
    Example: Polling citizens about their voting preferences.
23. **Case Study**
    Definition: An in-depth study of a single subject or group.
    Example: Examining the impact of industrialization on a small town.
24. **Observation Method**
    Definition: Watching subjects in their natural environment.
    Example: Observing children's behavior on playgrounds.
25. **Experimentation**
    Definition: Testing hypotheses under controlled conditions.
    Example: Analyzing group dynamics through role-playing exercises.
26. **Secondary Data**
    Definition: Using previously collected data for new research.
    Example: Analyzing census data for demographic studies.
27. **Research Ethics**
    Definition: Guidelines ensuring integrity and ethical treatment of subjects.
    Example: Obtaining informed consent from participants.
28. **Variables**
    Definition: Measurable elements that can vary in a study.
    Example: Age, income, or education level in sociological research.
29. **Correlation**
    Definition: A relationship between two variables.
    Example: Higher education levels correlating with higher incomes.
30. **Causation**
    Definition: When one variable directly affects another.
    Example: Smoking causing an increase in lung cancer rates.

Sociological Theories

31. **Functionalism**
    Definition: Views society as a system of interdependent parts.
    Example: Religion as a means of maintaining social order.
32. **Conflict Theory**
    Definition: Focuses on power struggles between groups.
    Example: Analyzing gender wage gaps.
33. **Symbolic Interactionism**
    Definition: Studies how individuals interact based on shared symbols.
    Example: The significance of wedding rings in marriage.

34. **Feminism**
    Definition: Analyzes gender inequality and advocates for women's rights.
    Example: Researching workplace discrimination.
35. **Post-Colonialism**
    Definition: Examines the lasting impact of colonialism on societies.
    Example: Studying cultural hybridity in former colonies.
36. **Post-Modernism**
    Definition: Challenges universal truths and focuses on subjective experiences.
    Example: Analyzing media's role in shaping identities.

Social Issues and Institutions

37. **Gender Inequality**
    Definition: Unequal treatment based on gender.
    Example: Disparities in leadership roles between men and women.
38. **Religion**
    Definition: A set of beliefs and practices related to sacred things.
    Example: Examining the role of rituals in community building.
39. **Family Structure**
    Definition: The organization of relationships within a family unit.
    Example: Nuclear versus extended family dynamics.
40. **Education**
    Definition: The process of learning and socialization within institutions.
    Example: Studying the effects of standardized testing.
41. **Globalization**
    Definition: The increasing interconnectedness of the world.
    Example: The spread of multinational corporations.
42. **Urbanization**
    Definition: The movement of populations to cities.
    Example: Examining the rise of megacities in Asia.
43. **Health Sociology**
    Definition: The study of social factors affecting health and illness.
    Example: Researching disparities in healthcare access.

Key Methodological Concepts

44. **Inductive Reasoning**
    Definition: Developing general theories from specific observations.
    Example: Observing classroom behavior to form theories about student motivation.
45. **Deductive Reasoning**
    Definition: Testing hypotheses derived from general theories.
    Example: Testing theories of inequality through income data.

46. **Empirical Evidence**
    Definition: Data derived from systematic observation or experimentation.
    Example: Survey results on public opinion.
47. **Hypothesis Testing**
    Definition: Assessing if a proposed relationship between variables is true.
    Example: Testing whether income affects voting behavior.
48. **Social Variables**
    Definition: Characteristics that influence behavior or social outcomes.
    Example: Religion, class, or ethnicity.
49. **Data Analysis**
    Definition: Examining collected data to draw conclusions.
    Example: Using statistical software to analyze survey responses.
50. **Theory Building**
    Definition: Creating frameworks to explain social phenomena.
    Example: Developing a theory on the causes of unemployment

B.Ed. (1.5 Years) BS English Files

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